UNESCO × EFAP • CREATIVE BATTLE

EDUCATION STARTS EARLY

Make the world see ECCE differently.

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12–16 October 2026 | Student creative brief

Your challenge in 30 seconds

One campaign idea. A message the world will remember.

Education starts early.

Investment in education needs to start early too.

01 THE CHALLENGE

Strengthen an existing UNESCO campaign.

02 THE AUDIENCE

General public, especially young adults.

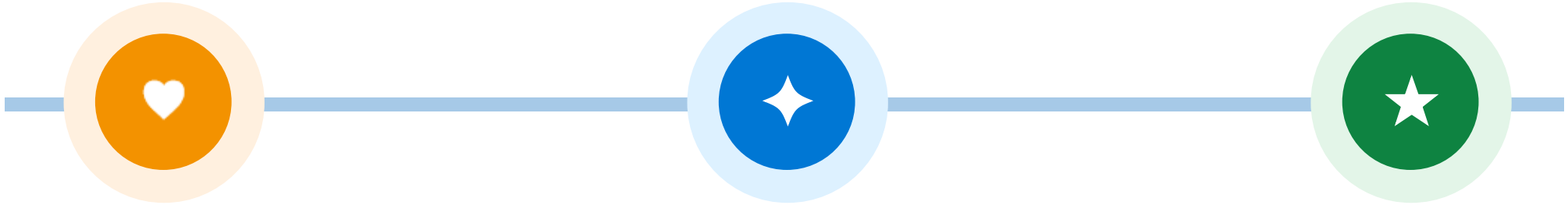
03 THE AMBITION

A recognizable idea that lasts beyond the launch.

Not an advertisement for the report — a campaign built around a human insight.

Where does education really begin?

Learning starts long before the first day of primary school.



Care & connection

First discoveries

Play & language

Curiosity grows

Skills & transitions

Learning continues

Learning happens through play, relationships, movement, language, care and discovery.



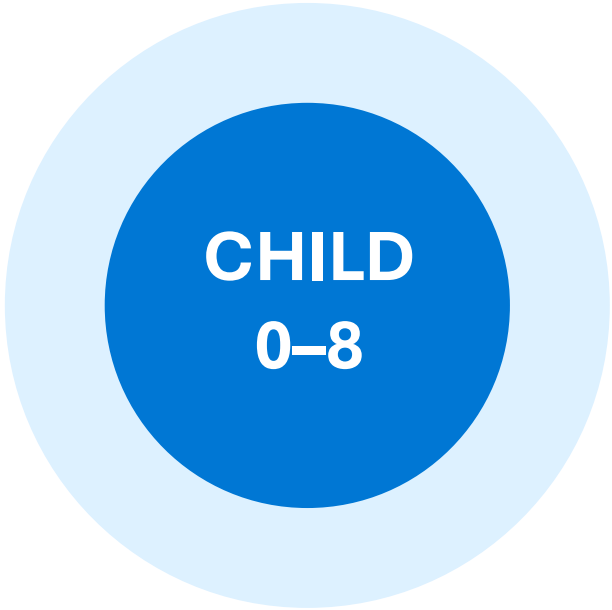
"ECCE is the term UNESCO and some countries use for multisectoral Early Childhood Development (ECD) that includes child health, nutrition, water, sanitation and hygiene, education and protection. However, ECCE usually emphasises inclusive early childhood education (ECE) with attention to initial education (0 to 3 years), parenting support, and pre-primary education, with less attention to childcare, health, nutrition, and protection (UNESCO, 2010). ECD is a fully multisectoral term that is used by most countries, agencies and networks. It includes all of the aforementioned sectors and emphasises the holistic development of the child in all developmental domains. Early Childhood Intervention (ECI) is a separate field that provides integrated services for children with at-risk situations, developmental delays and disabilities. ECI is usually led by education ministries in strong partnership with health and protection ministries"

https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000380077/PDF/380077eng.pdf.multi

Early childhood is more than schooling

ECCE is part of a holistic, multisectoral approach to early development.

ECCE highlights inclusive early education, parenting support and pre-primary provision — connected to health, nutrition, protection and care.



- LEARNING
- HEALTH
- NUTRITION
- CARE & PLAY
- PROTECTION

The creative opportunity

From a familiar image of school to a broader understanding of learning.

WHAT PEOPLE OFTEN PICTURE

A classroom. A school desk. A teacher. A diploma. The first day of school.

WHAT WE WANT THEM TO SEE

A child exploring, playing, communicating, connecting and learning from the earliest years.

CHANGE THE FRAME

The audience: keep it human

Speak to people who may never have heard of early childhood care and education.

01

WHO

General public, particularly young adults

02

HOW

Simple, emotional and visually arresting

03

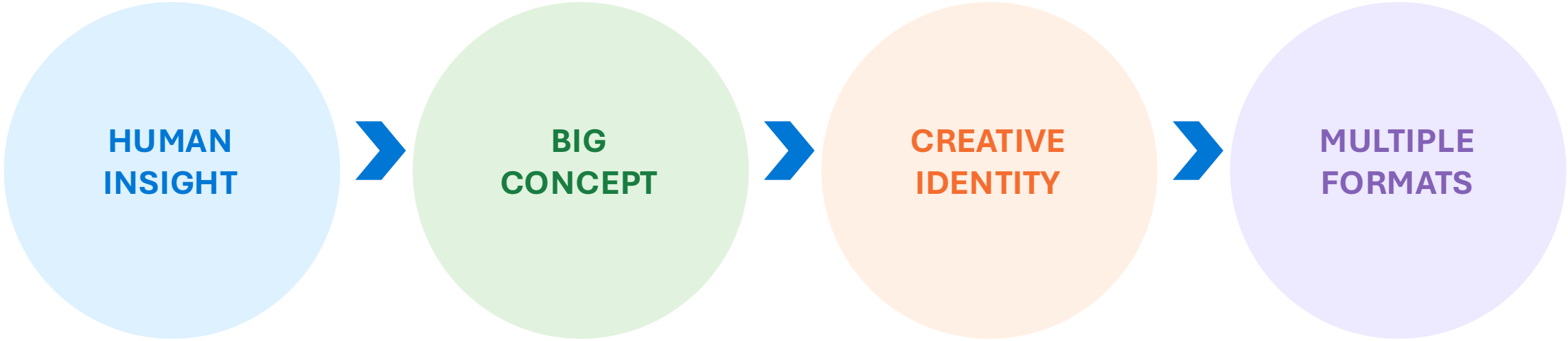
WHY

Make early learning personally relevant

The reaction to aim for: “Of course education starts early. Why have I never thought about it that way?”

The idea comes first

Create one coherent campaign — not six unrelated proposals.



One memorable thought → one visual language → many creative expressions

Six essential deliverables

Three days to make one compelling idea tangible.

01 Big concept & insight

One sentence + human truth

02 Key visual / poster

One memorable hero image

03 Video pitch

15–30 second idea

04 Social media

A few illustrative posts

05 Participation

One engaging activation

06 International adaptation

One relevant cultural or language example

What do the six outputs look like?

Concepts and prototypes are enough — production-ready assets are not required.

1

BIG IDEA

A single compelling sentence

2

HERO VISUAL

A campaign poster or developed mock-up

3

SHORT VIDEO

A script, storyboard or animatic

4

SOCIAL

Example post, story, carousel or Reel

5

ACTIVATION

An online or in-person engagement idea

6

GLOBAL

One adapted execution in another context

A three-day creative sprint

From the brief to a coherent campaign pitch.

1

DAY 1

MON 12 OCT

Briefing & immersion

Understand the audience, evidence and creative opportunity.

2

DAY 2

CREATIVE WORK

Concept development

Find the insight, build the visual and test formats.

3

DAY 3

FRI 16 OCT

Final presentation

Pitch the complete concept and respond to questions.

Finalist pitch • Approximately 20 minutes + 10-minute Q&A

Your creative compass

The strongest idea is instantly understood — and built to travel.

HUMAN

Start from everyday experiences.

SIMPLE

Make sense without jargon.

BOLD

Get noticed in seconds.

INCLUSIVE

Show diverse realities.

GLOBAL

Work across cultures.

CREDIBLE

Stay grounded in evidence.

The boundaries are clear

Be surprising while respecting UNESCO's existing visual identity.

DO

- Build around one human insight
- Be emotionally engaging
- Show diversity and accessibility
- Respect campaign and UNESCO branding

AVOID

- Heavy policy jargon
- Generic smiling-child imagery
- Pity-based or deterministic stories
- Unofficial redesign of the UNESCO logo

What makes a strong proposal?

The concept matters as well as the content produced.

1

CREATIVE STRENGTH

Originality + clarity

Does the concept make us feel and remember?

2

CAMPAIGN POTENTIAL

Identity + consistency

Does one idea work across all six outputs?

3

RELEVANCE

ECCE + early investment

Does it communicate a credible public message?

4

REAL-WORLD USE

Participation + adaptability

Could people share it in different contexts?

Where the 2026 Global Report fits

Evidence and inspiration — not the campaign's centre.

2026 REPORT

An evidence base: inclusive access, quality and financing.

YOUR BIG IDEA

One human, visually distinctive campaign concept.

GLOBAL PUBLIC

A message that lasts beyond any single launch.

19–20 November 2026 • An opportunity to amplify the campaign, not a requirement.

Education Starts Early: a campaign with roots

The message gained global visibility at the 2022 World Conference on ECCE in Tashkent.

WHAT THE CAMPAIGN SAYS

Learning begins before the first day of school. Strong foundations in early childhood help shape brighter futures for generations to come.

Education starts early.
Investment must start early too.

147	77	2,683
Member States	Ministers and vice-ministers	Participants



UNESCO World Conference on ECCE • Tashkent, November 2022

WHY IT MATTERS

- **Makes ECCE easy to grasp**
- **Shifts how people imagine education**
- **Connects early learning to public action**
- **Travels across formats and countries**

The Tashkent Declaration reinforced commitments to quality early childhood care and education and investment.

Relevant links & resources

Explore the campaign context, global commitments and inspiration for your creative concept.

Early childhood care and education

UNESCO thematic hub ↗

What you need to know about ECCE

Accessible overview and key facts ↗

2024 Global Report on ECCE

Background evidence and global priorities ↗

2026 Global Report — Launch information

Financing equitable and inclusive access ↗

Tashkent Declaration / World Conference on ECCE

Global commitments and conference materials ↗

Global Partnership Strategy 2021–2030

Long-term international cooperation ↗

Trello board — World Conference on Early Childhood Care and Education

Open the board to explore conference-related materials and creative references. ↗

Click any resource title or ↗ symbol to open the source in your browser.

THE QUESTION TO TAKE AWAY

How could you make someone see education differently in just three seconds?

One insight. One idea. Six expressions. Global potential.